

MEDIA ARTS

OVERVIEW

Media arts courses at the Grade 11 and 12 level focus on refining students' use of multiple media and their skills in the use of traditional and emerging technologies and tools. Students create increasingly sophisticated media art works that communicate ideas, feelings, and beliefs to specific audiences. These courses also develop students' theoretical knowledge and analytical skills, and encourage them to explore in greater depth the cultural, historical, and social contexts of media art.

Media arts incorporates a variety of materials, techniques, tools, technologies, and skills from various arts disciplines including dance, drama, music, and visual arts. Elements are also drawn from the contributing arts: for example, line, colour, and texture from visual arts; space, time, and energy from dance; rhythm (duration), harmony (pitch), and dynamics from music; and character, place, and tension from dramatic arts. The technologies and processes used and adapted to create media art may be traditional, including, but not limited to, photography, film, photocopy art, analog and electro-acoustic sound, classical animation, and video/television. The technologies and processes may also be digital: computer software, digital imaging and graphics, digital sound recording and sonic sculpture, two- and three-dimensional animation, multimedia production, holography, and web-page design.

Four organizing principles guide the creation of media artworks: *hybridization*, *interactivity*, *duration*, and *point of view*. Hybridization involves innovative ways of combining art disciplines to create what can be called "hybrid" forms of art. Duration explores the nature of time and how its perception can be manipulated and presented. Interactivity involves viewer participation and includes artforms such as interactive installations, performance art, gaming environments, and web-based art. Point of view can be expressed both conceptually – revealing, for example, an artist's response to a social theme or issue – and physically, through perspective.

The expectations for the courses in media arts are organized into three distinct but related strands:

1. **Creating and Presenting:** Students apply the creative process (see pages 15–17) to construct and present media art works using traditional and emerging technology and tools in increasingly skillful ways. They create art works for multiple purposes and audiences, reflecting on the effectiveness of their use of the creative process. Students analyse how various artists use the principles of media art in the design and production of works that integrate elements from contributing arts.

2. ***Reflecting, Responding, and Analysing:*** In this strand, students use the critical analysis process (see pages 17–22) and the process of deconstruction to enhance their appreciation of media art works. Students reflect on their artistic choices to determine their effectiveness. They examine how media art works reflect personal and cultural identities, and affect personal, cultural, and community values. They assess and refine the skills needed for a range of careers and lifelong learning.
3. ***Foundations:*** In this strand, students deepen their understanding of theoretical concepts and expand their vocabulary for evaluating their own creations and those of other media artists. They analyse the roles of media artists and explore the historical and sociocultural contexts of media arts. Students demonstrate responsible practices when producing, presenting, and experiencing media art works.

Media Arts, Grade 12

University/College Preparation

ASM4M

This course emphasizes the refinement of media arts skills through the creation of a thematic body of work by applying traditional and emerging technologies, tools, and techniques such as multimedia, computer animation, installation art, and performance art. Students will develop works that express their views on contemporary issues and will create portfolios suitable for use in either career or postsecondary education applications. Students will critically analyse the role of media artists in shaping audience perceptions of identity, culture, and community values.

Prerequisite: Media Arts, Grade 11, University/College Preparation

A. CREATING AND PRESENTING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1. The Creative Process:** apply the creative process to create media art works, individually and/or collaboratively;
- A2. The Principles of Media Arts:** design and produce media art works, applying the principles of media arts and using various elements from contributing arts (dance, drama, music, visual arts);
- A3. Using Technologies, Tools, and Techniques:** apply traditional and emerging technologies, tools, and techniques to produce and present media art works for a variety of audiences and purposes.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. The Creative Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- A1.1** use a variety of strategies (*e.g., brainstorming, concept webs, mind maps, advisory/production team discussions, research using a variety of sources*) to investigate increasingly complex creative challenges and to generate and organize innovative ideas, individually and/or collaboratively, for addressing these challenges (*e.g., the challenge of developing a virtual gallery*)

Teacher prompts: “What mix of individuals or teams might you bring together to generate a wider range of ideas?” “How did discussions between the advisory and production teams help to generate diverse ideas for addressing the creative challenge?”

- A1.2** develop detailed plans, individually and/or collaboratively, that address a variety of creative challenges, including increasingly complex challenges (*e.g., reflect on and filter their ideas to select a feasible one as the basis for their plan; use storyboards, thumbnail sketches, production notes, scripts, choreographic notes, and/or blocking notes to help develop their plans; with a partner, plan a media work using alter egos or, in the digital world, avatars*), and assess and refine their plans on the basis of feedback and reflection

Teacher prompt: “Does your plan cover all aspects of the design, production, and presentation of your art work? Have you reflected on problems that arose when producing earlier works to help you refine your current plan?”

- A1.3** produce and refine media art works, including increasingly complex art works, using research, exploration, input, and reflection (*e.g., research audio/visual codes and alternative media; extend their skills by experimenting with new tools and practising unfamiliar techniques; reflect on feedback from their teacher, peers, and others, and modify their preliminary work as appropriate on the basis of this feedback*)

Teacher prompts: “What sources might you explore to discover new techniques or innovative approaches that might be adapted for your own work?” “In what ways has your research and experimentation informed the initial development and final outcome of your art work?”

- A1.4** exhibit or perform media art works, including increasingly complex works, independently and/or collaboratively, using the most appropriate methods for the work (*e.g., present a performance-based installation with a soundscape in a space with effective lighting, sightlines, and acoustics; exhibit their digital works in a virtual gallery; present their animation at a school-wide film festival*)

Teacher prompt: “What mode of presentation is most appropriate for your art work? Why? How would changing the mode enhance or detract from your work?”

- A1.5** create a detailed record of their use of the creative process in the production and presentation of a media art work, using a tracking tool compatible with the medium/media used in that work (*e.g., a sketchbook showing modifications*)

to the design of their installation; a video of the development of a performance art piece), and use this record to determine, through reflection, how effectively they applied the creative process

Teacher prompts: “What sort of tool would be most effective for tracking the progress of your installation? Why?” “How has reviewing the creative process enriched your experience of producing this art work? What impact do you think this process might have on works you create in the future?”

A2. The Principles of Media Arts

By the end of this course, students will:

A2.1 investigate and analyse how media artists use the principle of hybridization, and apply that principle and at least one other principle in the design and production of media art works that incorporate elements from contributing arts (e.g., use video, performance art, and audio and the principles of hybridization and interactivity to create a multidimensional installation in the style of artists such as Tony Oursler or Angela Bulloch)

Teacher prompt: “In the hybrid media art works you have analysed, what other principles did the artists use? How does the combination of principles affect the impact of the work? How could you use similar principles to enrich and extend the impact of your media art work?”

A2.2 investigate and analyse how media artists use the principle of interactivity, and apply that principle and at least one other principle in the design and production of media art works that incorporate elements from contributing arts (e.g., develop a multimedia arts “intervention” that uses the principles of interactivity and point of view in the style of artists such as Yoko Ono or Margot Lovejoy)

Teacher prompt: “How has the artist used the principles of interactivity and point of view to organize the different elements in her media art work? Do you think she was successful? How might you adapt this approach for your own art work?”

A2.3 investigate and analyse how media artists use the principle of duration, and apply that principle and at least one other principle in the design and production of media art works that incorporate elements from contributing arts (e.g., using the work of Ron Haselden as inspiration, apply the principles of duration and point of view

to create a multimedia, site-specific group performance piece that is to be presented in a particular area of the school or the school grounds and that challenges or changes the space’s purpose or meaning; explore Juan Geuer’s Hellot Glasses as a possible source of inspiration for a media art work that combines the principles of duration and interactivity)

Teacher prompt: “Compare atemporal still images from your video with the time-based imagery. What impact does the combination of the principles of duration and point of view have on the viewer?”

A2.4 investigate and analyse how media artists use the principle of point of view, and apply that principle and at least one other principle in the design and production of media art works that incorporate elements from contributing arts (e.g., analyse a work such as Bruce Nauman’s World Peace, which displays many perspectives in multiple screen projections and uses hybridization and interactivity; produce, with other class members, a series of video or animation shorts that depict the same event or concept from different point of view and that integrate the principle of duration)

Teacher prompt: “How can the principle of interactivity be used to change the point of view of a media art work? How can combining these principles transform the way an art work is explored, experienced, and/or interpreted?”

A3. Using Technologies, Tools, and Techniques

By the end of this course, students will:

A3.1 explore a wide range of increasingly complex traditional and emerging technologies, tools, and techniques, and use them to produce highly effective media art works (e.g., extend skills by exploring complex tasks involving digital imaging, digital video, digital audio, multimedia, installations, and performance art; develop complex layers in digital imaging; use key frames and tweening in video editing or animation; design and block a performance in real space and time as well as virtual space and time; create web-based art, using software from the OSAPAC database where possible)

Teacher prompts: “Have you used this technology to produce other media art works? How might you extend your technological capabilities in this particular work?” “In what ways have your heightened skills contributed to your ability to choose and work with the most appropriate media for the task?”

A3.2 create and present media art works that are highly appropriate for a variety of specific audiences and venues (*e.g., an audience of students and their parents; a fringe festival audience; a venue such as a virtual gallery, a studio, or an outdoor site that is relevant to the particular art work*), using a range of technologies, tools, and techniques (*e.g., projection, broadcast, the Internet, computer monitors*)

Teacher prompts: “Why might your awareness of your audience and venue influence your design choices and presentation media?” “Did the technology you used to present your art work maximize the audience’s ability to experience the work? What might you change about the presentation to enhance the audience’s experience?”

A3.3 communicate their purpose and artistic intention when creating and presenting media art works, using a variety of approaches, tools, technologies, and techniques in an increasingly skilful and personalized way (*e.g., produce a non-narrative video that uses sound effects and images to challenge ethnic stereotyping in their school and larger community; produce a short documentary to raise awareness of a current Aboriginal issue, using an approach similar to that in Alanis Obomsawin’s works*)

Teacher prompts: “What technique could you use to help convey your message effectively to the audience? How could you modify this technique to put a more personal stamp on your art work?” “Explain how your creative decisions have helped you to effectively communicate your artistic intention.”

B. REFLECTING, RESPONDING, AND ANALYSING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. The Critical Analysis Process:** demonstrate an understanding of the critical analysis process by using it to monitor the creative process, and by examining, interpreting, assessing, and reflecting on media art works;
- B2. Identity and Values:** demonstrate an understanding of how media art works reflect personal and cultural identity, and affect personal, cultural, and community values and their awareness of those values;
- B3. Connections Beyond the Classroom:** demonstrate an understanding of the types of knowledge and skills developed in media arts and how they can be used outside the media arts classroom.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. The Critical Analysis Process

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1.1** interpret and assess the media art works of their peers, organize and communicate their findings in appropriate ways (*e.g., use a graphic organizer, an electronic feedback form, or a questionnaire to record their initial response to the work, their analysis of the work's technical and aesthetic components, their interpretation of its message, and their assessment of the work's effectiveness*), and reflect on how their feedback could be applied to their own media art works

Teacher prompt: “What is a useful way of recording your response to the art works created by your peers? What are some constructive ways of communicating your assessment to your peers? How can the processes of organizing and communicating your assessment help you in your own use of the creative process?”

- B1.2** use the critical analysis process to deconstruct, analyse, and evaluate different types of media art works (*e.g., interactive installations, animations, music videos, performance art, websites, digitally manipulated photographs, documentaries*) by contemporary media artists (*e.g., determine their initial reaction to an art work; identify the individual elements and principles of the work and analyse how the artist has combined them*

for a particular purpose; reflect on the work's technical and aesthetic features to determine its effectiveness in communicating a message, emotion, or concern and to assess its impact; analyse how Mona Hatoum uses projected video to communicate a sense of self in Corps étranger; assess the effectiveness of Don Kelly's A Fish Out of Water in providing insight into contemporary Aboriginal identities)

Teacher prompts: “How does the artist's selection of media and techniques contribute to the effectiveness of the art work? In what ways has your analysis of this media art work affected your opinion of the artist or his or her art work?” “Why might the aesthetic choices of an artist have different effects on different people?”

- B1.3** analyse how their interpretation and evaluation of a media art work evolved through each stage of the critical analysis process, and communicate their findings in a creative way (*e.g., in a presentation, a video journal, an annotated sketchbook, a blog, a digital recording*)

Teacher prompts: “How and why does increased understanding of an artist's intent affect your opinion or appreciation of an art work?” “What observations might you include in a one-minute short that communicates your new learning and understandings about an art work studied in class?”

B1.4 use the appropriate components of the critical analysis process throughout the creative process to assess the effectiveness of their decisions, to determine their next steps, and to analyse audience responses to their media art work (e.g., *analyse their approach to and decisions about planning, producing, and presenting their art work; incorporate into their creative practices knowledge and skills gained by critically analysing the art work of others*), and create a record (e.g., *a blog, a journal, a video documentary*) of how the critical analysis process has affected their creative decisions

Teacher prompt: “What insights did you gain by reflecting on the physical or virtual space and the mode of presentation for your art work? What did you learn from analysing the audience’s response to your work?”

B2. Identity and Values

By the end of this course, students will:

B2.1 analyse, on the basis of investigation, how media art works can express the evolution of artists’ personal identities over time (e.g., *investigate the Untitled Film Stills series of Cindy Sherman for insights they provide into her identity, and compare them to her later works*)

Teacher prompt: “What can a media art work reveal about the artist’s identity? How and why might media artists create an identity through their work that may not represent who they really are?”

B2.2 analyse, on the basis of investigation, the ability of media art works to express and promote cultural identities (e.g., *a media art work on the spirit or resilience of an Aboriginal culture*), and analyse how obstacles can limit that ability (e.g., *how galleries or the Internet might limit the representation of different cultures; how appropriation of ideas can affect the expression of identity*)

Teacher prompts: “What effect does ‘cyber-imperialism’ or ‘cyber-colonialism’ have on the types of media arts represented on the Internet?” “What are some of the ways in which Aboriginal media artists have portrayed their cultures? In what ways are these portrayals different from outsiders’ portrayals of these cultures? What accounts for these differences?”

B2.3 analyse, on the basis of investigation, how media art works can serve as a catalyst for changing community or societal values (e.g., *the use of filmmaker Leni Riefenstahl by the propaganda arm of the Nazi government in Germany*

in the 1930s; the advocacy role of documentaries such as Not a Love Story or If You Love This Planet)

Teacher prompt: “What methods do documentary filmmakers or photographers use to increase public awareness of their subjects and affect people’s beliefs and behaviour? Which methods do you think are most effective? Why?”

B2.4 assess, on the basis of reflection, and communicate (e.g., *in a formal artist’s statement*) the impact that creating and presenting media art works has had on the evolution of their personal values and their understanding of their culture and community

Teacher prompt: “In what ways have you developed as a media artist? What impact has this growth had on your own values? On your awareness of the values of your culture?”

B2.5 analyse how the process of critically analysing media art works has affected their perception and understanding of different communities, cultures, ideologies, and/or social groups, and assess the impact of these perceptions and understandings on their own media art work (e.g., *reflect on how their increased understanding of others’ points of view has affected the content or approach of their own art works*)

B3. Connections Beyond the Classroom

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 analyse, on the basis of investigation, the requirements for postsecondary studies that are related to media arts and that suit their personal skills, and create and maintain a personal portfolio that could be used when applying to programs in these areas (e.g., *assemble a digital portfolio that highlights their skills that would be relevant to a postsecondary program and that contains appropriate samples of their media art works; complete a self-assessment of their skills and competencies in one or more of the following areas: technical skills [in image manipulation, digital video editing, sound editing, multimedia authoring], management skills, innovation skills, interpersonal skills related to leadership and collaboration*)

B3.2 analyse and assess their personal skills and interests in relation to careers connected with design, production, distribution, or management processes in media art (e.g., *strong technological skills and interest in evolving technologies and media, incisive analytical skills, the ability to respond in a timely fashion to fast-changing*

demands, leadership and interpersonal skills, communication skills; the relationship between these skills and careers such as animator, artistic director, educator, entrepreneur, media critic, producer)

B3.3 analyse skills and understandings acquired through the creative and critical analysis processes in media arts (*e.g., creative, technical, analytical, collaborative, and communication skills; increased understanding of issues related to differently abled people and inclusion*), and analyse in detail how they can be applied in a wide range of areas in everyday life (*e.g., to*

analyse and help resolve a contentious issue in their school or local community; to write a review of a installation at a gallery and post it on a website; when volunteering for a social justice organization)

Teacher prompt: “How can you use the skills and knowledge learned in media arts to promote, and change people’s perspectives on, an issue of local, national, or global importance? What tools could you use to attract people’s attention and influence their perspective?”

C. FOUNDATIONS

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Terminology:** demonstrate an understanding of, and use correct terminology when referring to, elements, principles, and other concepts relating to media arts;
- C2. Contexts and Influences:** demonstrate an understanding of the sociocultural and historical contexts of media arts;
- C3. Responsible Practices:** demonstrate an understanding of responsible practices associated with producing, presenting, and experiencing media art works.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Terminology

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1.1** explain the stages of the creative and critical analysis process with reference to media art works, and explain and use correctly and appropriately a broad range of terms related to the conventions, concepts, principles, and elements of media arts when creating or analysing media art works (*e.g., create a media presentation to explain a range of genres, stereotypes, symbols, styles, icons, structures, and recipes used in media arts; use proper terminology when describing the conventions used in The Paradise Institute by Janet Cardiff and George Bures Miller*)
- C1.2** analyse, on the basis of research, how elements from contributing arts are applied through the principles of media arts (*e.g., how line from visual arts and space from dance can be applied using the principle of point of view; how the principle of hybridization can be used to integrate timbre from music and tension from drama*), and communicate their findings
- C1.3** explain in detail terminology associated with the application of technologies, tools, and techniques in the production and presentation of media art works (*e.g., produce an instructional manual that explains the terminology associated with the technologies, tools, and techniques they used to create a media art work*), and use this terminology correctly and appropriately when creating, presenting, or analysing media art works

C2. Contexts and Influences

By the end of this course, students will:

- C2.1** analyse in detail the connections between a contemporary media art work and related historical art works (*e.g., compare and contrast the use of text in media art works with its use in European or Arab illuminated manuscripts, Chinese or Japanese paintings that include kanji calligraphy, Egyptian tomb paintings that integrate hieroglyphics, or Aboriginal rock paintings that include pictographs; analyse how media artists use dynamic text or otherwise integrate the written word into their works; compare contemporary First Nation, Métis, and/or Inuit portrait photography, such as that in the Aboriginal youth magazine SAY, with the historical photographs of Edward Curtis*)
- C2.2** investigate and explain in detail the history and development of a range of media arts technologies (*e.g., the development of interactive media from early mechanical games such as pinball, through early digital games such as Pong, up to more recent interactive web pages and gaming media*)
Teacher prompt: "In what ways have gaming media changed over the past three decades? Describe the ways in which online role playing in gaming has affected actual communities and social/personal interactions."
- C2.3** analyse, with reference to specific artists and their works (*e.g., Rob Thompson's work in which he cages people*), the types of roles played by media artists in various societies,

and explain how their roles may vary depending on the sociocultural context in which they work (e.g., *how, in a society characterized by war or social conflict, the artist might promote the cause of one side in the conflict or might be an advocate for peace; in a totalitarian society, the artist might challenge restrictions on free expression; in a multicultural society, the artist might represent the cultural accomplishments of a minority group*)

Teaching prompt: “Why did Annie Leonard create the video *The Story of Stuff*? What role did she adopt in making this video? Why?”

C3. Responsible Practices

By the end of this course, students will:

- C3.1** assess and apply health and safety procedures when producing, presenting, or promoting media art works (e.g., *use studio safety checklists, modifying them as necessary to suit the type of studio work they are doing; apply safe practices when developing lighting and electrical plans; use appropriate stretching techniques before presentations that require movement; use appropriate vocal care practices; assess their work space and integrate ergonomic considerations into its design; use construction equipment and materials safely*)
- C3.2** demonstrate an understanding of ethical and legal issues in media arts, including issues related to intellectual property, social conflict, and discrimination (e.g., *freedom of expression and censorship of artists who challenge government policies; public access to work by artists from various sociocultural groups and representing a variety of perspectives*), and use ethical practices when creating, presenting, or promoting media art works
- C3.3** identify and apply responsible environmental practices associated with the media arts workplace (e.g., *dispose of chemicals, batteries, and obsolete hardware in environmentally safe ways; use energy conservation practices; use recycled or recyclable materials where possible; substitute more environmentally friendly materials for hazardous ones*)
- C3.4** identify a broad range of positive character traits associated with media arts production, and exhibit these traits consistently in both their independent work and their interactions with others (e.g., *show initiative at the outset of creative production processes; demonstrate cooperation and responsible leadership in a team environment; show respect for their tools and work environment and for the opinions of others*)
- C3.5** analyse conventions associated with the presenting and experiencing of media art works, and adapt these conventions to extend the ways they present and experience art works (e.g., *analyse the purpose and/or validity of traditional audience conventions; adapt these conventions as part of a media art work; challenge conventions for viewing or listening to traditional art forms*)